

Other Functions You Can Expect From Your MFD

- ❑ Scan multiple documents in batch processing mode and, optionally, OCR them
- ❑ Save the received fax on the computer and print only the needed faxes. Some MFDs may not provide this feature
- ❑ Scan photos and e-mail them
- ❑ Auto fax/phone switch: If you have one line for phone calls and faxing, some MFDs will switch to the fax function when a fax is incoming
- ❑ Broadcasting: Sends faxes to several different numbers simultaneously.
- ❑ Dual access: The ability to use the MFD for a second function while another function is being performed
- ❑ Fax memory: If your machine is out of paper, or the ink cartridge is low, faxes will be stored. When the paper tray is refilled or the cartridge replaced, the faxes stored in the memory chip will be printed. Some MFDs can store up to 500 pages
- ❑ PC faxing: Sends faxes directly from your computer's modem without having to print the document and feed it manually into the fax machine
- ❑ Quick scan: Scans a document into memory so you can retrieve your document without having to wait for it to be processed
- ❑ TWAIN: Allows importing graphics without leaving an application

A4 format heavy-duty MFDs

The four MFDs in the A4 format were Canon's iR1270F and iR1210, Xerox's M15i and Samsung's SCX-5315F. Both the models from Canon are identical save just one difference: the iR1270F has fax functionality thrown in. The iR1270F and iR1210 look better than Samsung and Xerox. Had it not been for their differing control panels, Xerox's M15i and Samsung's SCX-5315F would have looked like twins!

Printing

When it comes to features, there's hardly any difference among these models. All have a native printing resolution of 600 dpi—more than sufficient for most business needs. The paper trays provided with these MFDs have a capacity of 550 sheets. Canon, however, lets you increase the paper capacity by adding more trays for a complete 'fill it, shut it and forget it' operation. Samsung and Xerox don't offer this feature.

The models from Canon are rated to deliver 12 pages per minute and they come very close at 11 PPM. The Samsung and Xerox MFDs are both rated to deliver 15 PPM—Xerox delivered 14 PPM, and Samsung 13 PPM. In most of the printing tests, all the devices showed no significant difference in the results. However, in the combination-document printing test, the Canon MFDs were significantly faster, taking half the time as compared to the Samsung and Xerox. It's the same story in the photo-printout test. Though these devices aren't suited to print photographs, what's interesting is their behaviour while printing large files. This

Canon MFDs can print 99 copies at one go. In contrast, the Samsung and Xerox units can print a remarkable 999 copies. This apart, there are quite a few other features such as auto-fit, side-by-side copying, etc., that are exclusive to Samsung and Xerox

Great performer, with a software bundle that pushes it past the Xerox M15i for the crown

clearly indicates that the Samsung and Xerox printer units will slow down under heavy loads.

Scanning

Canon seems to think that large businesses don't need a dedicated scanner, so there's no 'Scan to PC' function in their devices. This means you can print and take copies, but you can't use the scanner for applications such as OCR, scanning images to PC, etc. The Xerox M15i and Samsung SCX-5315F have decent scanner units, with nearly all the features of a standalone scanner. They also scan an image or text directly to an e-mail client, or OCR software, and come bundled with basic document management software.

To simplify your scanning needs, an automatic document feeder is provided on all except Canon's iR1210. These multi-sheet document feeders come in handy when copying many documents, or when using scheduled fax.

Canon's MFDs lack a 'Scan to PC' feature, so we could not analyse the scan quality. However, when we made copies, we couldn't find any noteworthy defects in them. The scanner units on the Samsung and Xerox are almost identical, and do a superb scanning job. But be prepared to be assailed by a loud screeching noise as they scan!

Copying

The Canon units allow you to take a maximum of 99 copies in one go, whereas the Samsung and Xerox units allow 999 copies. Quite a few features such as auto-fit, clone, poster, side-by-side copying, etc., are exclusive to Samsung and Xerox. These add value to the units. Side-by-side copying helps you save paper by taking

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A4 Heavy-duty MFDs



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